



Behavioral Interview Blueprint

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Golden Idea

Behavioral interviews are extremely important to landing your dream software engineering job or internship — here's a complete guide on how to master them from scratch.

Importance

What's the main reason this idea is important to understand?

- Every single interview cycle has a behavioral interview, so you need to be able to pass them on a consistent basis.

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What is a Behavioral Interview?

A behavioral interview is a type of interview used in tech and software engineering (as well as other fields) to assess how you've handled situations in the past to predict future behavior. Instead of asking technical questions, the interviewer asks about your past experiences to understand your problem-solving skills, teamwork, adaptability, and other soft skills relevant to the job.

- Questions often start with phrases like “Tell me about a time when...” or “Give an example of...”.

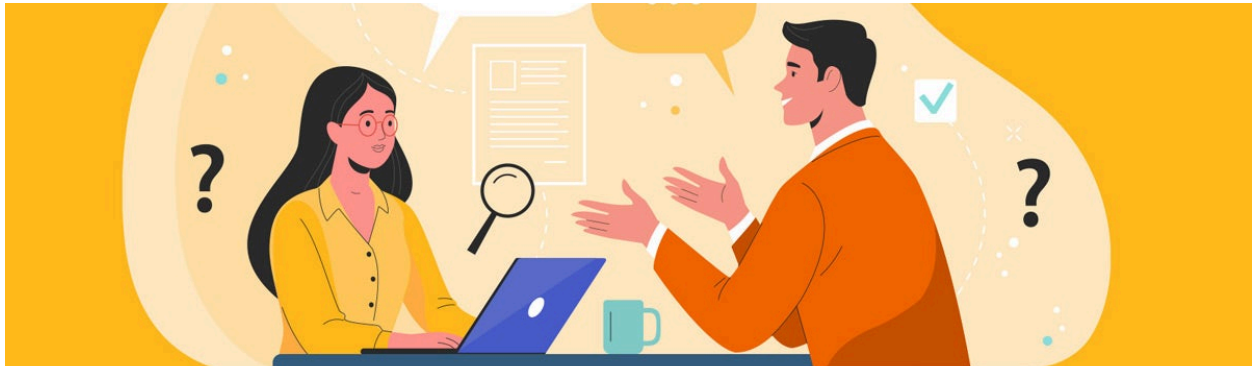
Companies conduct behavioral interviews to evaluate how candidates might perform in real-world work situations based on their past experiences. In tech and software engineering, strong technical skills are essential, but equally important are soft skills like communication, problem-solving, teamwork, and adaptability.

- Behavioral interviews help assess whether a candidate can effectively navigate challenges, work well in a team, manage conflict, and handle stress—all of which are critical for success in a collaborative and often fast-paced tech environment. By understanding how you've responded to situations in the past, companies can better predict how you'll behave in similar situations in the future.

Companies Need To Assess Culture-Fit

- Culture fit refers to how well a candidate's values, attitudes, behaviors, and work style align with the company's culture and environment. Companies assess culture fit to determine whether an individual will thrive within their team, adapt to their way of working, and contribute positively to the workplace atmosphere.
- In tech and software engineering, culture fit might involve assessing your comfort with collaboration, openness to feedback, adaptability to change, or whether you value innovation and learning—traits that match the company's core values and working style. A good culture fit helps ensure job satisfaction, higher performance, and longer tenure.

Technical skills are extremely important, of course, but so is culture. Tons of people are hired & then fired later on because the company didn't do enough due-diligence to assess the way they work.



Where Do Behavioral Interviews Fit in the Hiring Process?

Behavioral Interviews can take place at any point in the hiring process. Typically, they occur at the beginning or end, but again can happen any time.

We define a behavioral interview as any kind of interview where they ask general behavioral questions — as opposed to when they have you solve a problem or complete an assignment in front of them.

- These can be mixed in with technical interviews — it's super common to have 1 interview where you get some behavioral questions followed by 1-2 coding interview problems.

Some situations where you may experience a behavioral interview:

- **Phone Screen:** An initial conversation to assess a candidate's background, basic skills, and interest in the role.
- **Recruiter Screen:** Similar to a phone screen, usually conducted by a recruiter to determine if the candidate meets the basic qualifications.
- **Recruiter Call:** A more in-depth call with the recruiter to discuss experience, culture fit, and expectations.
- **Hiring Manager Interview:** A meeting with the hiring manager to evaluate the candidate's experience, technical fit, and cultural alignment.



🚫 Why People Undervalue The Behavioral Interview

One of the biggest mistakes people make in this entire process is undervaluing the behavioral interview. Almost every person I encounter thinks:

"It's ok, I'll just wing it & talk about myself without preparation, I can handle that part."

Here are some more flawed thought patterns that people have concerning behavioral interviews:

- **"My Technical Skills Are Enough"**: They believe that being highly skilled technically is sufficient to secure the role, underestimating the importance of communication, teamwork, and other interpersonal skills.
- **"I'll Just Be Myself"**: They think that being genuine and improvising during the interview will be enough without needing structured preparation.
- **"It's Common Sense"**: They may perceive behavioral questions as easy or obvious, believing they don't need to prepare specific examples.
- **"They Want to See My Personality"**: They might believe that behavioral interviews are solely about showing personality, rather than demonstrating relevant skills and past performance.
- **"I Have Plenty of Experience, I'll Just Talk About It"**: They assume that their experience will speak for itself without needing to present it in a structured, impactful way, such as through the STAR method.

The fundamental error is two-fold: *just because you can "talk about yourself" to your friends and family, does not mean you're ready to efficiently deliver a great answer to a behavioral question in a coding interview.*

- I know just as many people who have failed behavioral interviews as coding interviews.
- *Analogy: Running actually has 5-10x the injuries as rock climbing. Why? Because rock climbers know the danger & take proper precautions, whereas people just go out and run without considering injury and proper technique.*
- Behavioral interviews are part of EVERY hiring process, so you must become great at them. It's absolutely essential.



Categories of Behavioral Questions

There are three types of behavioral questions you might face in a behavioral interview — here's what you can expect at a high level before we dive into how to optimally answer/prepare for all of them.

1. Situational and Problem-Solving Questions

- These questions focus on past experiences and how you handled different situations. They are designed to assess your problem-solving abilities, teamwork, and adaptability.
- *“Tell me about a time when you learned a new programming language or technology quickly.”*
- *“Describe a situation where you had a disagreement with a coworker. How did you handle it?”*
- *“Give an example of a challenging project you worked on. What obstacles did you face, and how did you overcome them?”*
- *“Tell me about a time when you had to solve a problem with an ambiguous or incomplete set of requirements.”*
- *“Tell me about a time when you failed at something. What did you learn from the experience?”*

2. Personal Background and Motivation Questions

- These questions focus on understanding your motivations, experiences, and goals. They help assess if you are a good cultural fit for the company and how your past experiences align with the role.
- *“Tell me about yourself.”*
- *“Tell me about X position on your resume.”*
- *“Describe your experience with [X skill] listed on your resume.”*
- *“What are your greatest strengths and weaknesses?”*
- *Why do you want to work here?”*
- *“Why are you interested in working at a startup/big company?”*
- *“Why do you want to work in the X field?”*

3. Self-Reflection and Value-Based Questions

- These questions assess how well you know yourself and whether your values align with those of the company. They also evaluate your ability to reflect on your past actions and personal growth.
- *“What motivates you in your work?”*
- *“Tell me about a time when you had to make a difficult decision at work.”*
- *“What do you value most in a workplace or team?”*
- *“How do you handle feedback or criticism?”*
- *“How do you prioritize tasks when you have multiple projects or deadlines?”*



★ The Skeleton Key Framework: R-STAR-IP

A **skeleton key** is a master key designed to open multiple locks, typically by bypassing the internal mechanisms. It symbolizes universal access or the ability to unlock many doors.

I'm going to teach you the R-STAR-IP framework for answering behavioral questions which you will utilize to answer basically every single question. This is your most powerful tool in this process, and is what you'll need to stick to & memorize to do this well.

- This framework is my own version of the STAR framework: *The **STAR framework** (Situation, Task, Action, Result) originated in behavioral interviewing techniques, primarily developed by HR professionals to better assess candidates' past experiences and predict future job performance.*
- *It became popular in the 1980s as companies sought a structured method to evaluate skills beyond technical abilities, focusing on problem-solving, teamwork, and communication through real-life examples.*

Before we get into it, most behavioral responses should be **2 to 3 minutes** long. No more, no less.

- You'll quickly find out whether you're too long or too short in the mock interviews & practice. You'll need to get used to this ideal length.

R: Rephrase (10s)

- The first step is to rephrase the question & get confirmation that you're answering the right question (in a smooth way).
- Why? Two reasons.

- It helps solidify the question in your mind & makes sure you don't forget what your answering — lots of people blank out and completely forget the question (which is not good) and this prevents that problem.
- It gives you a few seconds to think before you need to jump right into a response.
- Here's a script for how to do this:
 - Interviewer: *example question: "Tell me about a time when you learned a new programming language or technology quickly."*
 - You: *"Good question, so just to confirm, you're interested in hearing about a time when I needed to learn a new language or framework quickly and the context around that?"*
 - Interviewer: *"Yes, that's correct."*
 - You: *"Awesome, sounds good..."*
- The key is to say "good question" and then restate the question in slightly different words. Trust me, this really does help you answer the question better rather than jumping straight into talking. It gives you a second to breathe.

S: Situation (30s)

- The next step in the R-STAR-IP framework is to break down the situation. You want the interviewer to lock on mentally to the background details BEHIND your story so they can easily follow along.
- It's similar to the exposition, the first line in almost any story — books always start with *"it was a cold, snowy night in December..."*
 - *In Star Wars, the situation would be Luke on Tatooine living with his aunt and uncle.*
- You'll want to hit *who, where, when* details quickly in the first paragraph of your response, just to create the setting. This is the context in which your task becomes relevant.
- Then, you'll explain *what* and *why* — this will be the backdrop behind your story answering their question.
- Example
 - *"Last year in my junior year of college, during my summer software engineering internship at Amazon in LA, I worked in Prime Video on one of the backend teams. We....."*
- This is very important — don't spend too much time on it.

T: Task (20s)

- Next, you'll explain the task — the specific objective you needed to complete & who gave it to you.
 - You'll want to be extremely specific here — *ex. in Star Wars, the Task is when Obi-Wan Kenobi comes over to Luke & tells him about his dad and that it's time to join the rebellion and take down the Empire.*
 - *Luke's task becomes helping Obi-Wan deliver the Death Star plans hidden in R2-D2 to the **Rebel Alliance**. Along the way, he also takes on the*

responsibility of rescuing Princess Leia and eventually joins the Rebels in their mission to destroy the Death Star.

- Example
 - *"My manager asked me to create 5 API attributes on Prime Video that Smart TVs can query and get the proper information to display, like isAmazonOriginal, isDolbyAtmos, and a few other ones. I had roughly 6 weeks to get this done & make sure they all worked correctly."*
- It can be as simple as that, you just want to be specific with WHO gave you the task, WHAT you need to accomplish, how long you had, and WHY it is important.
- This is why the Situation is important, you need to set the stage for the Task to make sense.

A: Actions (45s)

- Now, you'll go through all your Actions. Basically, what 2-3 things YOU did to complete the Task in the time period.
- The important part here is to make sure that you're super clear, so *"The first thing I did is X for Y reason, which lead to...."*
- Run through 2-4 different principles and behaviors you took — you want to show off your decision making skills here and ensure you're a good culture fit.
 - These show your maturity and need to be in line with the company's mission, values, and culture. For example, if the company is like Meta and cares about *Moving Fast*, and your Action is *"I spent 3 weeks planning before writing any code"* — that's a really bad Action in the context of the company.
- Give a principle/action, justify why you did it....repeat.
- *Luke teams up with Obi-Wan, the smuggler **Han Solo**, and Chewbacca. They infiltrate the Death Star, rescue Princess Leia, and manage to escape. After reaching the Rebel base, Luke joins the Rebel forces in the assault against the Death Star. He trusts in the **Force** to guide him during the final attack run.*

R: Result (20s)

- Your Result is what happened in the end — did you achieve your goal, complete your Task? Did the Actions work out? Many people forget this, but it's unbelievably important.
- Be Specific, Give Numbers, and Be Impressive
 - It's really important to be confident & specific here — basically, don't play yourself down, and ideally give a positive result.
 - You basically never want to end on a negative note — even if you made a mistake, you need to always end on a positive.
 - *"I made this mistake, but then later I fixed it using XYZ and did this positive thing in the end and still Won."*
- *Luke successfully fires the shot that destroys the Death Star, delivering a major victory for the Rebel Alliance and dealing a significant blow to the Empire.*
- This is what they will remember — they remember the Task and the Result, and less the other stuff. So it's important to get this right.

Okay, that's the STAR — these are the important additions to STAR that I always have you do, and they matter a lot.

I: Impact (20s)

- Impact is very important — you can think of it as the Result of the Result, or Result Squared. *Because of the positive change you made, what else happened?*
 - It's a second order effect. *For example, if your result is that you successfully implemented 5 API attributes, then the Impact is that one of the Clients had a successful launch and was able to utilize them....*
 - ex. *If your result on a tutoring story is that your students all improved their grades by 1 letter, then the Impact is that two of them got into their dream school when they were rejected before but accepted now and were super grateful.*
 - Think about what happens next as a result of the thing you did.
- Why? *Because it shows long term thinking makes your progress seem all the more impressive.*
- This level of answer takes your response to the next level, and is something you NEED to have. For every story you tell, you need to think about this.
- *Star Wars: His journey transforms him from a farm boy into a hero of the Rebellion, and he begins to embrace his destiny as a Jedi.*

P: Philosophy (20s)

- Finally, you'll end with philosophy — *what is the major takeaway you had from this experience & what did you learn?*
- *"ex. Through this experience, I really learned the value of constant iteration and seeking feedback — if I had just asked my manager/mentor to review my changes briefly every few days, I would've caught so many issues early on and pivoted much faster."*
- Again — this is SO important, because it shows that you are able to think deeply and reflect on your experiences. Companies want someone who is coachable — if someone can learn, they are a WAY better asset than someone who's completely fixed in their ways.
- Ideally, you use one of the company's values as your learning — maybe not the exact wording, but a version of it.
 - For example, Amazon has 'Bias for Action' as one of their leadership principles — so you could adapt that for your learning if interviewing for Amazon.
 - This is another reason why you really want to deeply study the company's history, culture, values, mission before the behavioral interview.
- That's the Skeleton Key (R-STAR-IP) framework, and is what you're going to use to answer almost every single behavioral question going forward.



Story Selection

Now that you know how to tell a story in response to a behavioral question, how do you know what to actually talk about?

- You will have **3-5 stories that you modify** for every single question — this is very important. You need to isolate 3-5 experiences and know them like the back of your hand. Once you know your 3-5 stories, you usually just continue to reuse them over & over again.
- note: **you have the liberty to change small details here & there**. No one is checking, so if you want to modify timeline, results (slightly), people, etc. — you have the freedom to do that, and it is something I WOULD recommend.
 - I'm not saying make up a story — but if you want to fluff things up / move things around, you can.
 - You'll be modifying small details to fit the nuances of the question better. *ex. You're telling a story about an internship project, and the question is about a disagreement with a coworker. Just make up / play up that aspect of the story and brush over other unimportant details.*

At the end of this module, I'm going to give you a list of 30+ behavioral questions. You'll need to look through 5-10 of them & think about which story you will use for each and that is how you come up with your stories.

- For the accompanying worksheet, you'll need to fill out the R-STAR-IP for 3 questions off the list of 30. You'll also have a section below where you briefly explain your 4 stories that you'll be modifying for all behavioral questions.

In terms of your story choices, you almost always want them to be about technical experience / technically related — unfortunately, no one really cares about your personal stories, challenges, lifestyle, etc.

- If possible — if you truly have no technical experience, then pick something related to work or school.



How Technical Should You Be?

A common question I get is how technical should you be in your response — **it varies based on your audience**. If you're talking to a software engineer, then you can afford to include more technical details & information — if you're talking with a recruiter, then you need to be more high-level & talk more about the business aspect of things.

- If it's a nontechnical audience, go **“business reason → technical choice”**. Always have that in there.

There are two things that will change:

- The level of technical jargon, terms, and depth you explain in all aspects.
- Your Actions should be less technical if it's a non-technical audience, and focus more on the decision-making, business value, and work style.
 - *ex. I used this framework for X reason vs I used this learning technique to dive into a language.*
 - One is less technical but still relevant and useful.

Before your response, **ALWAYS think about your audience & who you're speaking to.**



💡 Mission, Values, Culture

These three elements are very important to understand when answering behavioral questions, and will steer the direction you take with your stories & answers.

- A company's **Mission** is its overarching purpose—what it aims to achieve or provide. It defines the company's goals and its reason for existence.
- **Values** are the core principles or beliefs that guide a company's actions and decisions, reflecting what is important to them (e.g., integrity, innovation, customer focus).
- **Culture** refers to the shared behaviors, attitudes, and practices within the company. It shapes the work environment and influences how employees interact, collaborate, and align with the company's mission and values.

Meta (formerly Facebook) vs. Patagonia

Aspect	Meta	Patagonia
Mission	"Bring the world closer together."	"We're in business to save our home planet."
Values	Innovation, Impact, Speed, Openness	Environmental Stewardship, Integrity, Quality
Culture	Fast-paced, competitive, tech-driven	Purpose-driven, sustainability-focused, balanced
Focus	Technology and global connection	Environmental responsibility and social activism

Meta emphasizes tech innovation and global connectivity, while Patagonia focuses on sustainability and protecting the environment.

You need to closely study these three before ANY behavioral interview because your answers must be in line with them. And as you can see, it differs wildly based on the company.

You'll want to include mission & values in many of your responses, but avoid being too on-the-nose about it

- *If something is overly obvious or too direct, it might be criticized as being "on the nose," implying there's no subtlety or nuance.*
- Don't ever say the exact wording of the value if you're not explicitly referring to it.



? Question-Specific Guide

There are some specific questions that come up commonly that I'll give you a formula for answering here.

Most of the time, you're still using STAR, but are appending or pre-pending additional portions.

1. Tell Me About Yourself

○ Start with a Quick Introduction (5-10 seconds)

- Begin by stating your name, your major, and your school (if applicable).
- **Example:** "Hi, I'm Aman, a computer science major at [University]."

○ Highlight Your Skills and Experience (10-15 seconds)

- Focus on technical skills that are relevant to the job, such as programming languages, frameworks, or specific projects.
- Mention any internships, research, or projects that demonstrate your abilities.
- **Example:** "I've completed internships focused on backend development using Python and Node.js, and recently worked on a project where I optimized an algorithm for a machine learning model."

○ Express Your Interest in the Company (5-10 seconds)

- Mention why you're interested in the company and what excites you about their work or mission.
- This shows you've done your homework and are genuinely interested.
- **Example:** "I'm particularly excited about [Company's] work in cloud computing, especially your innovative approach to scaling distributed systems."

- This should be around 1 min long.

2. Why This Company?

○ Why do you want to work for Company X?

- Common question, and comes up very often. You need to have this ready for EVERY company you interview for.
- Mission → Company Value You Resonate With → Tie back to an experience of yours where you used that value/addressed the mission and it had a positive impact (STAR).
 - You'll start with a theme about what you like and what you're planning on doing in general which ties back to a past experience you had.
 - We're still using STAR but it's modified slightly, as you're starting with mission/value and leading into your story.
- *Example. One of the biggest reasons I want to work for Meta is Meta's mission to "bring the world closer together". I'm passionate about using technology to create meaningful connections, and I believe Meta's platform has the global reach and impact to make this happen. Another reason is because one of the values Meta emphasizes is openness, both in terms of communication and sharing knowledge, which really aligns with my personal belief that transparency fosters innovation. In my previous role, I led a team that was building a communication tool that actually was aimed at increasing transparency across departments... (story continues with STAR-IP format).*
- Finish by rephrasing "and that's some of the big reasons why I want to work for Meta."
 - Pay attention to time, you'll probably need to shorten your STAR slightly in this response as there are some other aspects to it.

3. Why [Other Aspect]?

- Why A Startup? Why Robotics? etc.
- You'll use the same formula as "Why Company", but go with [aspect of X that you resonate with → STAR that shows your experience with that aspect and why you are excited about it]

4. What Are Your Strengths & Weaknesses?

- For strengths, do the same thing — pick a strength that is a value of the company & then tell a STAR to show it.
- For weaknesses, you'll want to pick a weakness that is secretly a value of the company & do the same.

- For example, if the company is Meta which has a value to “Move Fast”, then you can say your weakness is that “*sometimes I don’t give enough time and attention to look at all the options and consider every aspect of a problem before acting.*”
- You’re basically saying that your weakness is something they like — but it’s not obvious. Don’t clearly state “my weakness is I move fast”, because you’re being too explicit. You need to obfuscate it a little bit.
 1. Use the value but don’t say the exact words.
- In addition, you should explain that you’re not going the complete other way either — don’t make it seem like you think Acting Fast is always bad — just tell a story that shows that (while Acting Fast is usually good) sometimes you should take a second to consider more options before moving.

5. Tell Me About X On Your Resume

- This is also pretty common, so you need to be prepared to explain anything on your resume in this format.
 - It could be an Experience, Project, Skill, etc.
- Just explain what you did in the R-STAR-IP framework — if it’s a full work experience, then you’ll start by addressing at a high level what the role is (in Situation) → pick a Project and STAR that.
- **Example.** *Absolutely, so last year I interned at Amazon in the Prime Video Department in the Los Angeles office. My team was focused on the backend & specifically built the service that all Smart TVs query to get information on movies/TV shows...my project was related to.....*
- You’ll start high level, but quickly STAR your project.



6. Where Do You See Yourself in 5-10 Years / Your Future Career?

- In this case, they're trying to assess your long-term fit & whether you'll be there in the long run.
 - The biggest mistake people make is saying "this role is a stepping stone for something else" — NEVER say that.
 - In an interview, MrBeast said that sometimes potential employees will say "this role is a stepping stone to get into mainstream media" — and he automatically rejects them after that.
 - You should never say this role is a means to an end, that you're using it to build experience, etc.
 - You need to say that you care about them in the long run — that the culture/mission inherently resonates with you & that you want to be there long term.
 - Study the career path of someone at the company and find out where they are in 10 years.
 - Here's how you'll respond:
 - You're going to essentially say you want to be at their company in the future, but don't be too obvious:
 - **Example.** for Gekko Robotics: *"To be honest, I would love to see myself working in a fast-paced, robotics environment in the next 10 years. Ideally, by that point, I'm a senior engineer or manager, but I still want to be helping accelerate the robotics revolution & create real impact for X, Y, Z reasons. Now, I would absolutely love it if I could do that at this company of course, but as long as I'm working on something I genuinely care about and pushing robotics forward I'm happy....."*
 - You don't need to take that exactly — but I'm trying to show you that you need to consider their perspective and say what they want to hear.
- **Go Specific & Deep, Not Shallow & Wide**
 - Most people (especially in Why questions) tend to rattle off a list of high level, generic traits they like — this is a mistake. You need to hyperfocus on 1-2 things in your response, and tell a full story about those.
 - Your response should not work for **any other person or any other company** — if it does, that's a major red flag and is something you need to pay attention to.
 - Don't ramble off languages.



- *I know Java, Python, JavaScript, etc.*
- *This is like a builder rattling off the tools they can use rather than the houses they've built.*

● When You're Not Detailed Enough

- Some people struggle with being detailed enough. They feel like they don't know what to say or how to keep on expanding.
- Here's a quick framework you can use to do that:
 - Think about describing your experience as pulling a thread.
 - Anytime you say something, keep asking yourself "Why? Why? Why?" and more and more detail will appear.
- This can also be helpful when writing your stories in the assignment. If you're struggling to come up with enough detail, just double click on any specific bullet or portion and explain it further.

● Delivery & Speech

- Your delivery (the way you speak) is incredibly important & is almost as important as the content of what you say...so you need to make it as good as possible.
- Be Happy & Confident
 - You'll want to avoid monotone, sounding upset/sad, and be as musical and happy as possible.
 - Ex. of what vs what not to do here (what the difference sounds like).
 - Confidence is a proxy for competence — if you think all the way back to Psychic Job Hunting, the brain uses heuristics to shortcut decision making — and confidence is one of these.
 - If you seem confident, the interviewer subconsciously assumes that you're better & more qualified.
 - The best way to improve this is to record yourself & listen back — you'd be shocked by how bad you probably sound, and the only way to improve is to listen to it.
- Reduce Fillers
 - Most of us speak with tons & tons of fillers. People use fillers like "um," "uh," "like," and "you know" when speaking for several reasons, including buying time to think, easing nervousness, or maintaining control of the conversation.
 - Fillers often emerge when the speaker is unsure of what to say next or wants to avoid pauses that may feel awkward.

While these words can sometimes help keep the conversation flowing, they can also distract the listener, reduce the speaker's credibility, and make them appear less confident or prepared.

- *Um, uh, like, you know, well, so, actually, basically, literally, right*
- You want to 1) isolate which fillers you frequent and 2) remove them as much as possible.
 - You do this by listening back to your behavioral interview tapes & slowing down!
 - Instead of using a filler, just pause and allow silence in. People have anxiety about silence, which makes them think that a filler is useful.
- Avoid Long Pauses
 - On that note, while short pauses are okay, you want to avoid long pauses (longer than 3-5 seconds).

● Questions to Ask at the End of the Interview

- At the end of most interviews, the interviewer will ask you “do you have any questions for me?”
- You NEVER want to say “Nope!”. Always ask 2-3 questions.
- Here are two questions that I usually go for that you can keep in your back pocket for the interview:
 - “Can you share a bit about your journey and how you landed at this company? What do you enjoy the most about working here?”
 - This question shows genuine interest in the interviewer's personal experience and gives you insight into the company culture and what makes it special.
 - “In your experience, what are the key characteristics of a successful new grad or intern at this company?”
 - This question helps you understand the qualities the company values in its employees and gives you a better idea of how to align your strengths with their expectations.
 - It also associates a good engineer with YOU in their mind — which is something you want to do.



Behavioral Question Mega List & Assignment

Assignment: Take 3 of these (and 'Tell Me About Yourself') and record a 2-4 minute behavioral interview response and submit them into the homework assignment.

- Try to incorporate all the advice in this video to have a great response.
- Then, you're going to listen back to all 4 recordings & write a few bullets about what you'll improve for next time.

General Behavioral Questions:

- Tell me about yourself.
- Why do you want to work for our company?
- What is your greatest strength, and how has it helped you in your projects?
- What is your biggest weakness, and how are you working to improve it?
- Why did you choose to study computer science/software engineering?
- What are your short-term and long-term career goals?
- Why are you interested in this particular role?
- Describe a time when you had to learn a new technology or programming language quickly. How did you handle it?
- Tell me about a time when you had to meet a tight deadline. How did you manage your time?
- How do you handle stressful situations or pressure?

Teamwork and Collaboration:

- Tell me about a time you worked in a team to complete a challenging project. What was your role?
- Describe a situation where you had a disagreement with a teammate. How did you resolve it?
- How do you approach giving or receiving constructive feedback?
- Tell me about a time you had to explain a technical concept to someone without a technical background.
- How do you prioritize tasks when working on a team project?
- Have you ever had to lead a team? How did you manage it?

Problem-Solving and Challenges:

- Tell me about a time you encountered a major challenge in a project and how you overcame it.
- Describe a situation where you made a mistake on a project. How did you handle it?
- How do you approach solving problems you're unfamiliar with?
- Tell me about a time when your initial solution to a problem didn't work. How did you pivot to find a better solution?
- Describe a time when you had to make a trade-off between quality and speed.
- Tell me about a time when you had conflicting priorities. How did you handle them?

Leadership and Initiative:

- Have you ever taken the lead on a project or team? How did you manage that responsibility?
- Describe a time when you saw a problem and took the initiative to solve it.

- How do you handle situations where you disagree with your manager or team leader?

Adaptability and Growth:

- Tell me about a time when you had to adapt to significant changes during a project.
- How do you handle learning from failure? Can you give an example?
- What do you do to stay up-to-date with the latest developments in technology?
- Tell me about a time you had to deal with ambiguity in a project. How did you navigate through it?
- Describe a situation where you had to quickly pivot due to changing requirements. How did you adjust?

These questions focus on your ability to work well with others, adapt to challenges, and demonstrate self-awareness and initiative—all essential qualities for a software engineering intern or new grad.